

# Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a three-part setting (Soprano, Alto, and Tenor/Bass) in 3/4 time, with a key signature of two flats (B-flat and E-flat). The score is divided into four systems, each with a treble and bass staff. The lyrics are written below the staves, with three verses of text aligned under the notes. Chord symbols are placed above the staves to indicate the harmonic structure.

**System 1:** Chords: E $\flat$ , Fm, B $\flat$ , E $\flat$ .  
Lyrics: 1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,  
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,  
3 And since to look at things in bloom

**System 2:** Chords: E $\flat$ , A $\flat$ , B $\flat$  sus, B $\flat$ , E $\flat$ .  
Lyrics: hung with bloom a - long the bough,  
twen - ty will not come a - gain.  
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

**System 3:** Chords: A $\flat$ , Fm, G.  
Lyrics: it stands a - bout the wood - land ride  
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,  
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

**System 4:** Chords: E $\flat$ /G, Gm, Fm, B $\flat$ , E $\flat$ .  
Lyrics: wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.  
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.  
see the cher - ry hung with snow.